Student Builder Group Leader Article Brief

Your personal guide to writing AWS Builder Center articles!

Hello Student Builder Group Leaders!

We're thrilled to have you as part of our initiative to grow AWS Builder Center's presence on campuses across the globe.

Preparing for the future can feel especially overwhelming when you're a student. **AWS Builder Center allows anyone, at any skill level, to connect with builders who understand their journey.**

The goal of this document is to guide you through how to write insightful articles that share your unique student builder experience. *Let's dive in together.*

Your ***unique*** *voice* is why you were chosen for this opportunity, and we want your unique experience and point-of-view to ***shine*** in your writing.

We want you to ***share your leadership journey***, inclusive of both your challenges and breakthroughs.

Here's a few building blocks for how to harness that:

This is who I am and where I started.

IDENTITY

This was the "unlock" that helped me to grow.

COMMUNITY & LEARNING

This is how AWS Builder Center empowers my aspirations.

PASSION & PURPOSE

Here's a few building blocks for how to harness that:

This is who I am and where I started.

IDENTITY

This was the "unlock" that helped me to grow.

COMMUNITY & LEARNING

This is how AWS Builder Center empowers my aspirations.

PASSION & PURPOSE

GUIDING QUESTION(S)

**What's your name, school, and major?
What sparked your interest
in cloud computing?**

Here’s a few building blocks for how to harness that:

This is who I am and where I started.

IDENTITY

This was the "unlock" that helped me to grow.

COMMUNITY & LEARNING

This is how AWS Builder Center empowers my aspirations.

PASSION & PURPOSE

GUIDING QUESTION(S)

How do you prefer to learn?

What creates a sense of real community for you?

Here's a few building blocks for how to harness that:

This is who I am and where I started.

IDENTITY

This was the "unlock" that helped me to grow.

COMMUNITY & LEARNING

This is how AWS Builder Center empowers my aspirations.

PASSION & PURPOSE

GUIDING QUESTION(S)

What are you working towards?

How does AWS Builder Center and your SBG help you make progress towards your aspirations? What advice would you give to a peer trying to work towards their aspirations with AWS Builder Center?

Here's a few building blocks for how to harness that:

This is who I am and where I started.

IDENTITY

This was the "unlock" that helped me to grow.

COMMUNITY & LEARNING

This is how AWS Builder Center empowers my aspirations.

PASSION & PURPOSE

Think of each of these as "checkpoints" to include in your articles as you explain your journey with AWS Builder Center. You may have a different "destination" (aka each article topic), but articles should seek to incorporate these general grounding points.

Let’s do an exercise together to define your unique point of view…

Again, this is intended to help you brainstorm and grasp your personal point of view, NOT to be explicitly used within your article(s). Use this as a starting point, not the finish line!

IDENTITY

Hi, I'm ______________________ and I am a ______________________
[NAME] [YEAR IN SCHOOL]

at ______________________ studying ______________________ .
[SCHOOL] [MAJOR]

I became interested in cloud computing when ______________________
[SCENARIO]

______________________ .

COMMUNITY & LEANRING

I learn new skills best by ______________________ .
[ACTIVITY OR STRATEGY]

I feel like I belong when ______________________ .
[ACTIVITY OR BEHAVIOR]

PURPOSE

Something I'm working towards is ______________________
[SHORT-TERM GOAL]

and I hope to ultimately ______________________ .
[LONG-TERM GOAL]

BRAND

AWS Builder Center helps me to grow my confidence/skills by ______________________
[ACTIVITY OR BEHAVIOR]

and I hope to inspire that same growth in others through ______________________ .
[ACTIVITY OR BEHAVIOR]

Again, this is intended to help you brainstorm and grasp your personal point of view, NOT to be explicitly used within your article(s). Use this as a starting point, not the finish line!

IDENTITY

Hi, I'm Elizabeth [NAME] and I am a senior [YEAR IN SCHOOL]

at The University of Iowa [SCHOOL] studying Computer Science [MAJOR].

I became interested in cloud computing when I started my entry-level courses and discovered the level of complexity it takes to power the simple tools we use on the internet everyday [SCENARIO].

COMMUNITY & LEANRING

I learn new skills best by hands-on experiments & exercises [ACTIVITY OR STRATEGY].

I feel like I belong when can take part in shared experiences with like-minded people [ACTIVITY OR BEHAVIOR].

PURPOSE

Something I'm working towards is building my own mobile app [SHORT-TERM GOAL]

and I hope to ultimately become a software engineer [LONG-TERM GOAL].

BRAND

AWS Builder Center helps me to grow my confidence/skills by giving me the freedom to try [ACTIVITY OR BEHAVIOR]

and I hope to inspire that same growth in others through conquering challenges together [ACTIVITY OR BEHAVIOR].

The Ask

Choose an article topic from Page 19 and write (4) four articles throughout your 12-month tenure that showcase your personal experience working within the AWS Builder Center and leading your Student Builder Group.

We have five guidelines to help you craft great articles, but the golden rule is to be specific.

Avoid...	**Try Instead...**
I learned a lot about leadership...	**"Enforcing hard caps on workshop tracks prevented crowd chaos — without them, we had ~30 failed attendance validations"**
The event was a great success...	**"600+ attendees across 3 tracks, 45 volunteers. Our digital gatepass process check-ins in less than 8 seconds."**
AWS services are powerful...	**"We used Bedrock's Web Grounding API to give the Scout agent real-time access to funding databases – here's the code snippet"**
I met many great people...	**"Steve pulled me aside at the Orange Digital Center in Douala and said..."**

To test, ask yourself – **Could someone else have written this sentence without having your experience?** If yes, it's too generic. Replace it with something only you know.

Guideline #1

What Great Looks Like

Writing

Strong

Clear, well-structured, proofread. Flows naturally from one idea to the next.

Needs Improvement

Incomplete sentences, missing sections, reads like a first draft.

Real World Connection

Your article should feel like a great podcast conversation: ***clear, engaging, and easy to follow***

What Great Looks Like

Depth

Strong

Includes architecture, code, real data, cost/performance details.

Needs Improvement

Names services and concepts without explaining any detail.

Bonus Tip: Utilize links when possible! Direct readers to specific places within the AWS Builder Center to show where you've traveled.

Behind the scenes teaser: AWS at SIGGRAPH 2021 keynote presentation | Amazon Web Services

Amazon Web Services · 1.8K views • 4 years ago

A short teaser for the upcoming "behind the scenes" video walks through how the SIGGRAPH 2021 keynote presentation "Through the looking glass: the next reality for content production" was created...

AWS Behind the Cloud

Amazon Web Services · Playlist

AWS Behind the Cloud: Meet David Appel, AWS WWPS Vice President | Amazon Web Services • 8:07

Real World Connection

Your article should feel like a behind-the-scenes video: ***showing how everything actually works.***

Guideline #3

What Great Looks Like

Originality

Strong

A unique perspective that only this author could provide.

Needs Improvement

Could have been written by anyone without the experience.

****Bonus Tip: Headlines matter! Make sure you grab readers' attention with an engaging title that captures your unique experience.***

Real World Connection

Think of your favorite influencer. You follow them for their ***ownable voice and unique content.***

Guideline #4

What Great Looks Like

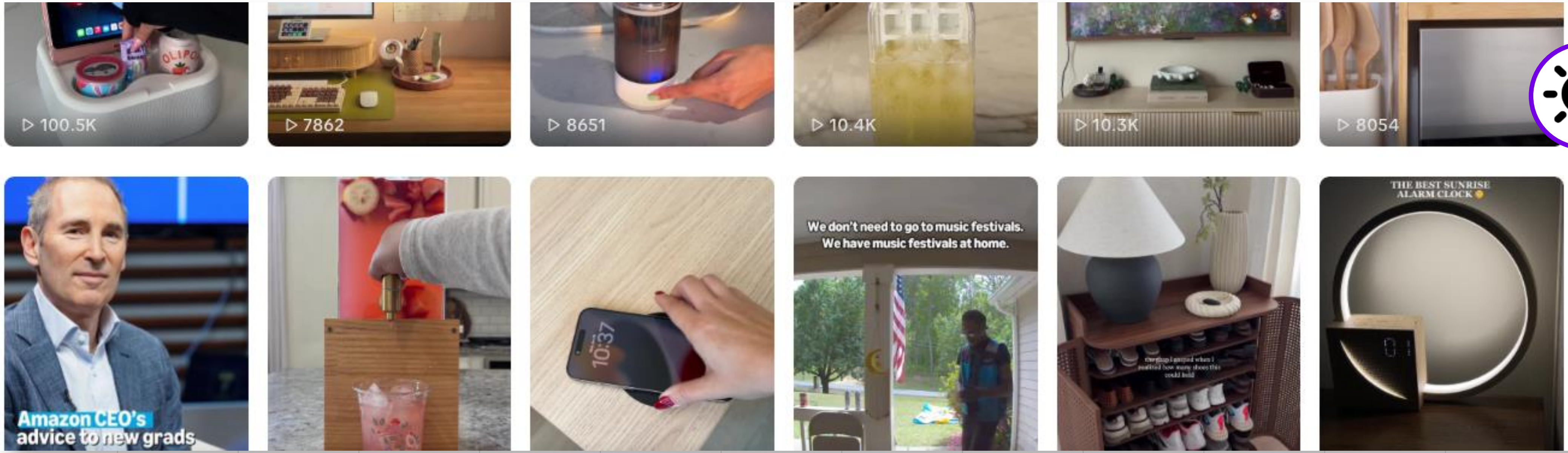
Usefulness

Strong

A reader can replicate what you did, apply your advice, or build on your work.

Needs Improvement

The reader learns nothing they couldn't find on the first Google result.



Real World Connection

Think of the most recent TikTok video you saved – you knew ***the content could help you at a later time.***

Guideline #5

What Great Looks Like

Formatting

Strong

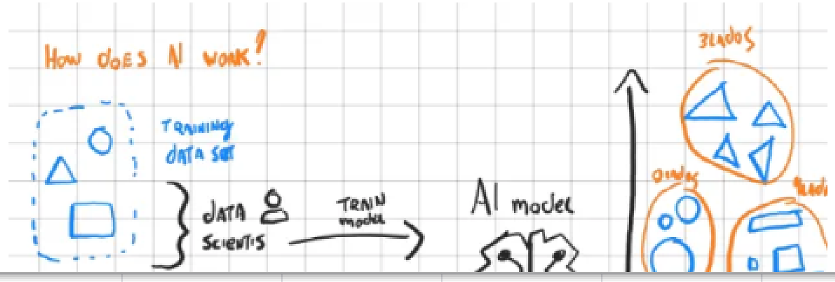
Images, code blocks, tables and headings
break up the text and
aid comprehension.

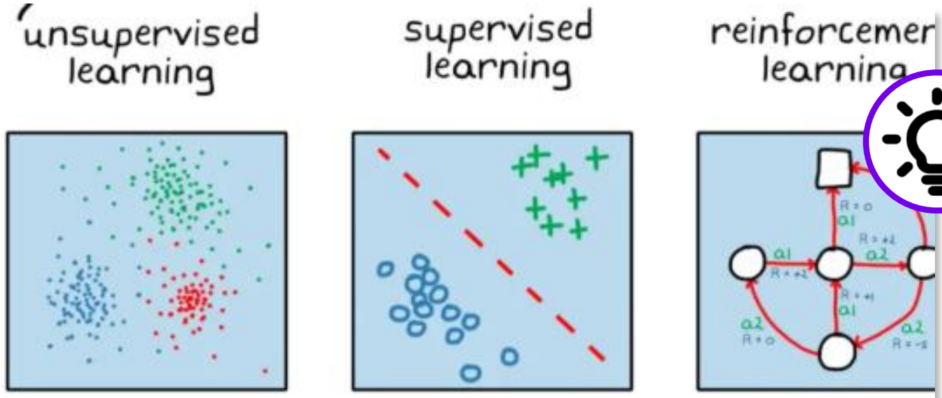
Needs Improvement

A wall of text with no structure or visuals.

To make this work, AI is structured in layers:

1. **Data Layer** — where large volumes of data live
2. **ML Framework & Algorithm Layer** — where data scientists and engineers define use cases, requirements, and learning frameworks
3. **Model Layer** — where the model is implemented and trained, with its structure, parameters, ar optimization functions
4. **Application Layer** — where the trained model becomes a product and reaches the end user





The way data is presented to the model defines the training paradigm. Each approach serves a differ purpose:

Supervised Learning — the model learns from labeled data. If input X → output Y. It's the most com and straightforward: spam detection, price prediction, image classification.

Real World Connection

Your article should look like a magazine where ***visuals + writing make the story come to life.***

Image & Article Source: [AI Fundamentals for the AWS AI Practitioner] by Rafael Napolitano Vescovi

Let's get into the specifics...

Sample Article Topics

Tips & Tricks

Identify your favorite features or tools within AWS, and showcase how they can unlock new possibilities for other builders.

Structure: Tactical

Case Study

Describe the most recent challenge you overcame using the community and resources available from AWS Builder Center.

Structure: Chronological

Community Stories

Describe what makes your campus chapter unique, and how you find new opportunities to keep building and learning with one another.

Structure: Anecdotal

Pre-Event Promo & Post-Event Recap

Share in detail about a recent gathering or event coming up on your campus.

Structure: Anecdotal

Tips & Tricks

Identify your favorite features or tools within AWS, and showcase how they can unlock new possibilities for other builders.

What this is: A **tactical list** that clearly outlines a specific challenge and the solutions / tips you uncovered to solve

Great Example HERE

Must Include:

- ❑ The AWS services you used
- ❑ A "what's next" section pointing to related topics
- ❑ Common errors and troubleshooting tips
- ❑ CLI/SDK Alternatives
- ❑ Cost estimates

Avoid: Generic tips that people can search for on their own

Sample Headlines & Thought-Starters:

5 Game-Changing Techniques for Beginners Starting on AWS Builder Center

What would you recommend to someone just starting out on AWS Builder Center, and what has made the biggest difference in your experience?

3 Initiatives to Get the Most from Your Student Builder Group Community

How can other students maximize the opportunities available to them through their on-campus Student Builder Group?

Case Study

Describe from the most recent challenge you overcame using the community and resources available from AWS Builder Center.

What this is:

A **chronological** deep dive that starts with the problem you solved and clearly states your architecture & tech stack, implementation walk through, results and the lessons you learned

Great Example [HERE]()

Must Include:

- ❑ Architecture overview (1-2 paragraphs)
- ❑ The AWS services you used + why you chose them (with diagram)
- ❑ Implementation walk through – code, config, gotchas
- ❑ What broke and how you fixed it
- ❑ Cost or performance considerations
- ❑ Results + Metrics
- ❑ Lessons learned

Avoid:

Naming AWS services without explaining design decisions

Sample Headlines & Thought-Starters:

How AWS Builder Center Helped Me Take My Capstone Project from Idea to Execution

Take us through the journey– what challenge did you uncover? What tools within Builder Center did you use to problem-solve? What went right and what would you do differently?

How I Began Building A Mobile App with Workshops for AWS Amplify

How did you use a specific AWS product offering to reach a goal?

Community Stories

Describe what makes your campus chapter unique, and how you find new opportunities to keep building and learning with one another.

What this is:

An **anecdotal** story that is unique to your personal journey filled with specific details and real moments that demonstrate to the community the type of leader you are

Great Example HERE

Must Include:

- ❑ A specific narrative arc
- ❑ Named people, places and moments
- ❑ At least one moment of vulnerability or failure
- ❑ Something the reader can apply to their own journey

Avoid:

Generic stories – if it feels like your name could be replaced by any other Leader's, look back to the "Must Include" section

Sample Headlines & Thought-Starters:

How I Found my Crowd through my AWS Student Builder Group

What made it possible to form meaningful connections with members of your SBG? How does the community in-person feed into the community online?

The Impact I Was Able to Make as an AWS Student Group Leader – And Why You Should Become One, Too

If you could give advice to someone considering applying to become a Group Leader, what would you say? What do you wish you knew earlier on?

Pre-Event Promo & Post-Event Recap

Share in detail about a recent gathering or event coming up on your campus.

What this is:

An **anecdotal** story that helps future attendees understand either what to expect from events in the future, OR what knowledge they'll gain after attending

Great Example HERE

Must Include:

- ❑ Concrete numbers (registrations, attendance, budget, volunteer count)
- ❑ What worked well and what didn't – be specific
- ❑ Actionable advice for the next organizer
- ❑ Named speakers and session topics (not just "we had great speakers")

Avoid:

- Using vague superlatives like "incredible", "amazing", "life-changing"
- Writing a LinkedIn post – avoid doing team shoutouts that take up the majority of the article
- Stock phrases like "the energy in the room was electric"

Sample Headlines & Thought-Starters:

An AWS Hero is Coming to Campus – Here's What I'm Most Excited to Ask

How are you preparing to get the most out of experienced professionals coming to campus? What should others know to have the most valuable discussion?

What I Took Away from our Hackathon Event, and How I'm Already Preparing for the Next One

What did you learn at a recent event, and how did it change how you think about the events to come?

Checklist: Before You Hit Publish

Run through this checklist before publishing. If you can't check at least 8 of 10, your article may need more work.

- ❑ **Does my title accurately describe the content?** (Don't promise "Scalable Architecture" and deliver a paragraph)
- ❑ **Is every section complete?** (No empty bullet points, no placeholder text, no "TBD")
- ❑ **Have I included at least 3 specific details** that only I would know?
- ❑ **Have I included at least 1 failure, challenge, or mistake** and what I learned from it?
- ❑ **Are my numbers real?** (attendance, budget, metrics, performance data)
- ❑ **Have I added images, diagrams, or code** to breakup walls of text?
- ❑ **Have I proofread** for grammar and incomplete sentences?
- ❑ **Is this longer than 500 words?** (Anything shorter is asocial media post, not an article)
- ❑ **Would a reader learn something actionable?** (Not just "AWS is great" — but how to do something)
- ❑ **Have I removed generic motivational filler?** ("The future is cloud," "Never stop learning," etc.)

Continuing the Conversation with Comments & Follows

One of Amazon's core principles is to *Learn and Be Curious.*

Leaders are never done learning and always seek to improve themselves, so we encourage you to take every opportunity to interact with articles written by your peers and engage in a deeper dialogue.

Here are a few guiding best practices when writing comments:

1. **Engage meaningfully in discussion.** Pose new, open-ended questions that dive deeper into the subject matter.
2. **Encourage continued discovery.** Link to additional resources within AWS Builder Center that relate to the discussion.
3. **Offer suggestions when possible.** Continue to share your building experience with relevant, helpful tips when suitable.

Thank you

Article Best in Class Examples

(with callouts)

Tips & Tricks

This article on [tips for writing CDK tests](#) clearly outlines a specific challenge and the solution / tips that were uncovered to solve

Guideline #2: Depth
AWS Services Used

1. Use the assertions module

Something of a no-brainer, but use the tools you're given! One of the best parts of the CDK library is the assertions module. It contains two sections. One for "fine-grained" assertions, like what you would write during unit testing. The other is for performing "snapshot" tests, in which you compare the new template against one that is already deployed. It's a section of the library that can be easily missed but provides so much value when used correctly.

2. Make any Nested Stacks easily accessible

One of the benefits of using CDK is the ability to create declarative dependency trees. But, testing the implemented Nested Stacks can be tricky. One of the best ways I've found to simplify this is to add Nested Stacks as properties of the Stack class that handles deploying them. For example…

```
import SubStack from 'substack-stack.ts';

export class TopStack extends Stack {
  constructor(scope, id, props) {
    const subStack = new SubStack(this, 'substack', props);
  }
}
```

Is pretty standard. While it is possible to test this, you can simplify the process by "stashing" a reference.

```
import SubStack from 'substack-stack.ts';

export class TopStack extends Stack {
  subStack: SubStack;
  constructor(scope, id, props) {
    this.subStack = new SubStack(this, 'substack', props);
  }
}
```

Now accessing this for fine-grained assertions can look like…

```
import { Capture, Match, Template } from "aws-cdk-lib/assertions
import * as cdk from "aws-cdk-lib";
import { TopStack } from "top-stack";

describe("TopStack", () => {
  test("has the substack", () => {
    const app = new cdk.App();
    const topStack = new TopStack(app, "topStack", {});
    const { subStack } = topStack; // we pull the substack through

    // Pass the subStack to template.
    const template = Template.fromStack(subStack);
  }
}
```

3. Write your template to a file (sometimes)

Guideline #4: Usefulness
Common errors & troubleshooting tips

While writing assertions, you can find situations where the tests are failing for reasons that may not make sense. When this happens, one of the first things I will do is write the CloudFormation template out into a file. This way you can get a cold hard copy of what it is you are building in your hand. Rather than trying to parse through complex logs or mysterious error messages. Not a guarantee but often getting to see the complete output can solve many common testing pitfalls.

Conclusion

Testing is great! Testing your infrastructure… Even better! If you're just getting started with CDK or if you've been around since the early days, I hope these tips can help you along your journey! If you have any tips you'd like to add, share them in the comments. Always looking to learn more!

Find me on LinkedIn | Github

Case Study

A great example is [this multi-agent AI platform write-up] that covers architecture, code snippets, security layers, and cost analysis all in one article.

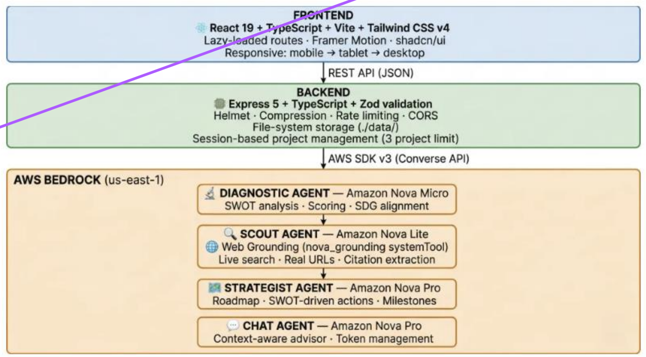
Guideline #1: Writing
Architecture Overview

Guideline #4 & #5: Usefulness & Formatting
AWS Services, why you chose them (with diagram)

How I Built This

Architecture Overview

The platform is a multi-agent application orchestrated as a phased pipeline using Amazon Bedrock's Converse API, with Firebase Authentication for user management and a Node.js/Express backend:



AWS Services Stack

Service	Role	Free Tier
Amazon Bedrock	AI model inference (Converse API)	Nova token allowances
Amazon Nova (Micro, Lite, Pro)	Foundation models for all 4 agents	100M/25M/10M tokens/month
Nova Web Grounding	Live internet search via `nova_grounding` systemTool	Included with Nova Lite
Strands Agents SDK	Declarative multi-agent orchestration framework	Open source
Amazon Bedrock AgentCore	Managed agent runtime & deployment	Free Tier eligible

Why Nova Micro? It is the fastest and cheapest model on Bedrock, ideal for structured classification tasks. Temperature is set to 0.5 for consistent outputs, with 2,500 max tokens.

```
// Example DiagnosticResult
{
  sector: "Agriculture",
  region: "Sub-Saharan Africa",
  maturity: "Concept",
```

Guideline #2: Depth
Implementation Walkthrough

Infrastructure Services:

Service	Usage	Free Tier Allowance
AWS Lambda	~5 functions, <300s/invocation	1M requests + 400K GB-s/month
Amazon API Gateway	REST API, ~5 routes	1M API calls/month
Amazon DynamoDB	2 tables (projects + sessions)	25 GB storage + 25 WCU/RCU
Amazon S3	Frontend static hosting	5 GB storage + 20K GET requests

Guideline #2: Depth
Cost or performance considerations

With the 3-project limit per session, a typical usage generates ~25,000 tokens total per full analysis — well within free tier bounds. The serverless architecture (Lambda + API Gateway) means **zero cost when idle**.

Guideline #4: Usefulness
Results + Metrics

What I Learned

1. Multi-agent orchestration is about context propagation, not just chaining

The single biggest insight was that the value of a multi-agent pipeline comes not from running multiple models, but from how you propagate context between them. The diagnostic output isn't just "consumed" by the scout — it fundamentally reshapes what the scout searches for. The user's expressed needs don't just "filter" opportunities — they shape the entire search strategy and roadmap structure.

Guideline #3: Originality
Lessons learned

Community Stories

This article about [AWS Community Day Cameroon] works because it includes real moments – buying matches for a fellow volunteer, travelling without money for a return ticket, overcoming the pride of speaking broken English.

Guideline #1: Writing
Specific Narrative Arc

Guideline #1: Depth
Named people, places, & moments

In June 2024, I participated in the City Hack Yaoundé, organized by MountainHub and CITS (Cameroon International Tech Summit), a 48-hour hackathon. During the event, people were talking about the AWS Community Day Cameroon in Douala. I decided to go even before the hackathon began. Right after the results were announced (which, though not in our favor, didn't discourage me), I headed to Douala without enough money for the return trip. Yes, I was crazy—but I didn't want to miss this event. It was a first in Cameroon, and it revolved around a technology that intrigued me, even though I didn't really know much about it beyond the term "cloud"—a word I often heard with Google Cloud, being a GDSC Lead Alumni and GDG Organizer Yaoundé.

When I arrived in Douala for the event, I saw **Dejon Fah Joël Xavier** —at the time, the only familiar face, since he was on my hackathon team. While checking in, I learned he was one of the event volunteers. Wow! I suddenly felt like more than just a participant. It felt like I'd missed out on a lot because I hadn't seen the volunteer call and didn't realize some volunteers had been working on the event's success for a long time, even meeting the day before.

Then I saw **NGUESSONG SUZY**, another familiar face from the Google I/O Extended Yaoundé, which I helped organize as a GDG Organizer Yaoundé. But everything changed when I spotted **Steve Yonkeu**. That was the turning point: while Joel and Suzy were volunteers, Steve was one of the main organizers. When I went to say hi and he remembered me, I expressed my desire to join the volunteer team. He pointed me toward **Delia Ayoko**, whom I was meeting for the first time, wearing a sweatshirt with an AWS Cloud Club logo—a term completely unknown to me at the time but one that sparked pure curiosity.

The Final Magical Moment

To wrap up, the most magical moment—the one that immortalized the experience—was the photo sessions and networking. I took the opportunity to gather all the new and former AWS Cloud Captains for a group photo and even brought together people who had never met outside of virtual meetings. In that moment, I felt like a thread connecting passionate tech enthusiasts.

It's nostalgic to think that just a year ago, I was a volunteer, and this year, I was an organizer… So, what's next?

Guideline #3: Originality
Vulnerability

And Now? Toward AWS Community Builders

As a Gold Captain, I'm committed to organizing the first-ever **AWS Student Community Day Cameroon**. Stay tuned—you'll hear about it soon.

And now? I'm applying for the **AWS Community Builders 2026 program** to amplify this impact and connect the AWS Cameroon community on a global scale.

Guideline #4: Usefulness
Something someone can apply

Thank you for reading. More to come in future articles, and I'll share personalized insights in my upcoming posts.

Follow my journey toward becoming an AWS Community Builder!

#TechEvangelist #AWSCommunity #AWSCameroon #CloudJourney #CommunityBuilders #AWS #Networking #TechCommunity

Pre-Event Promo & Post-Event Recap

See how this SCD Jalandhar Retrospective openly discusses crowd chaos, broken attendance validation and what they'd change next time.

Guideline #2: Depth
Concrete Numbers

Event Day: What Actually Happened

Arrival Patterns & Crowd Management

- Reporting started at **8:30 AM**
- Event start time was **9:30 AM**
- A major arrival surge occurred around **9:45 AM**
- Approximately **80% of attendees arrived during this short window**

Despite planning a buffer, the sudden concentration of arrivals created congestion during the opening session in the auditorium (capacity ~2.5K). This was one of the first real lessons of the day: **people do not arrive evenly, especially for large student events.**

Guideline #2: Depth
Specific Session Topics

Tracks & Workshops

We introduced **three parallel workshop tracks**:

- AI/ML
- Cybersecurity
- DevOps

These were chosen deliberately as they are among the most relevant and emerging fields for students today. Each workshop track had a **capacity of ~250 seats.**

Track selection was marked as mandatory during registration, but we intentionally avoided forcing students into rigid choices, as we wanted them to attend sessions, they were genuinely interested in.

Key Takeaways for Future SCD Organizers

Guideline #4: Usefulness
Sharing actionable advice

- Expect arrival surges, plan for peak, not average
- Do not rely only on communication; enforce physically
- Mandatory selections need real enforcement
- Institutional dependencies (like DL) must be over-communicated
- Attendance systems must be enforced at entry, not post-event
- Free events require stricter operational discipline

Personal Reflection as a Student Leader

This event was a strong learning experience for me. The most challenging part was ensuring compliance at scale, getting hundreds of students to follow instructions in real time. If I were to do this again, I would restrict crowd movement near venues much more strictly and work with the university for stronger compliance support.

While there were flaws, I'm glad I took this on. The experience taught me **what not to do**, and more importantly, how to plan better for future events. These learnings will directly shape upcoming AWS Cloud Club activities and future Student Community Days.

Would I organize another SCD again? **Yes.**
But I would do it with these lessons firmly in place.

Guideline #3: Originality
What worked well & what didn't